

Script Code	v26cb07ge0110
Title	Understanding Soil Types and Crops
Chapter	The Story of Indian Farming
Logline	Through the journey of a student travelling across India, the presenter explains how different soil types influence the crops grown in each region.
Grade	07
Writer	Vasudha Prasad
Final Sign-off	Rahul Marar
Key takeaway	● KT1: India has a wide variety of soil types. ● KT2: Each type of soil has different properties. ● KT3: Different soils support different crops. ● KT4: Soil and crops are closely connected.
Mini Takeaway	● KT1MT1: India has six major soil types. ● KT1MT2: These include alluvial, black, red, laterite, desert, and mountain soils. ● KT2MT1: Each soil type differs in nutrients and texture. ● KT2MT2: Soil properties affect plant growth. ● KT3MT1: Crops grow best in suitable soil conditions. ● KT3MT2: Farmers choose crops based on soil type. ● KT4MT1: Soil and crop patterns are linked across regions. ● KT4MT2: This creates agricultural diversity in India.
Pitch Doc Link	Link
Textbook	Link
Word Count	

Presenter	
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FADE IN:

FSA: Classroom – students doing a planting activity

The teacher gives three pots. Same seeds placed in all three. Different soils in each pot (dark, red, sandy)

PRESENTER(V.O.)

In a classroom activity, three students plant the same seeds in three different pots.

Split screens:

All 3 are watered, given sunlight.

PRESENTER(V.O.)

They water the plants regularly, place them in sunlight, and take care of them equally.

Close-up – three pots

Pot 1: dark soil

Pot 2: red soil

Pot 3: sandy soil

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Everything else is the same: the seeds, the water, and the care.

But one thing differs– the soil in each pot.

Split Screens:

Pot 1: healthy plant

Pot 2: average growth

Pot 3: weak plant

PRESENTER(V.O.)

After a few days, the results, too, are very different.

One plant grows strong and healthy, the second one grows slowly, and the third struggles to grow at all.

Was it just luck, or is there something important that we cannot see easily?

Well, plant growth depends a lot on the type of soil.

TOS5: Plant growth depends on the type of soil.

CUT TO:

INT. STUDIO - DAY

The Presenter is standing in the studio.

PRESENTER

To understand this, we need to look at something very important—

(beat)

...the different types of soil.

CUT TO:

TOS1: Types of Soil in India

CUT TO:

FSA: [Map of India](#) with coloured soil regions (refer img 1.9, 1.10 in textbook)

PRESENTER (V.O.)

India has a wide variety of soils, each has its own unique properties.

These differences are not just about colour, they affect how water is stored, how nutrients are available, and how plants grow.

CUT TO:

INT. STUDIO - DAY

The Presenter is standing in the studio.

TOS10:

Major Soil Types:

- Alluvial soil
- Black soil
- Red soil
- Laterite soil

- Desert soil
- Mountain (alpine) soil

PRESENTER

The major soil types are: alluvial, black, red, laterite, desert, and mountain (alpine) soils.

Each of these behave differently, which is why they support different kinds of crops.

Let's understand this step by step by looking at a few examples.

TOS110 ENDS.

TOS1: Soil Properties and Crops

CUT TO:

CUT TO:

FSA: Alluvial soil, River flowing, Soil being deposited, Green fields with crops wheat & rice (river plains)

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Alluvial soil, found in river plains, is highly fertile because it contains a mix of fine particles and nutrients deposited by rivers.

It holds enough moisture and nutrients, making it ideal for crops like wheat and rice.

TOS5: Alluvial soil is fertile and ideal for wheat and rice.

Black soil, Dark soil, Cracks when dry, Cotton plants growing → cotton

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Black soil is dark in colour and has a special ability to retain moisture for a long time.

It becomes sticky when wet and develops cracks when dry.

This makes it particularly suitable for growing cotton.

TOS5: Black soil retains moisture and is ideal for cotton.

Red soil, Reddish soil, Dry appearance, Millets growing millets & pulses

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Red soil gets its colour from iron content.

It is less fertile compared to alluvial soil and does not hold water very well.

Therefore, crops like millets and pulses, which need less water, are commonly grown here.

TOS5: Red soil supports low-water crops such as millets and pulses.

Laterite Soil, Heavy rainfall, Soil being washed, Plantation crops (tea/coffee)

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Laterite soil forms in areas with heavy rainfall, where nutrients are washed away from the soil.

This makes it naturally less fertile , but with proper care, it can support crops like tea and coffee.

TOS5: Laterite soil forms in high-rainfall areas and supports tea and coffee.

Desert soil, Sandy land, Very little vegetation, Dry conditions → sparse crops

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Desert soil is sandy and dry, which means it cannot hold water easily.

Because of this, farming is difficult, and only a few crops that can survive

dry conditions are grown in these conditions.

TOS5: Desert soil has low water retention and supports limited crops.

Mountain (Alpine) Soil, Sloping land, Terrace farming, Fruit orchards

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Mountain soil is found in hilly regions and is often uneven and shallow.

Because of the slopes, farmers use terrace farming.

This soil supports fruits and spices, especially in cooler climates.

TOS5: Mountain soil supports fruits and crops suited to cooler regions.

Side by side: Alluvial soil, Black soil, Red soil, Laterite soil, Desert soil, Mountain (alpine) soil.

PRESENTER(V.O.)

Each type of soil has its own properties. Some hold more water, others have more nutrients, and some are better suited for certain crops.

That is why farmers must understand their soil before deciding what to grow.

Now let's go back to the classroom experiment.

Three pots again

PRESENTER(V.O.)

The plants grew differently because each soil created different growing conditions.

Some soils had more nutrients, some held more water, and some could not support growth well.

CUT TO:

INT. STUDIO - DAY

The Presenter is standing in the studio.

PRESENTER

We can now clearly understand the main idea.

Soil is not just the ground beneath us—it is a key factor that decides what crops can grow and how well they grow. That is why different regions of India cultivate different crops—based on soil and climate.

But soil is not lifeless.

(beat)

It is a dynamic system that supports life.

Let's explore that next.

FADE OUT:

SUMMARY

- India has six major types of soil.
- Each soil has distinct properties.
- Soil type affects crop growth.
- Different crops grow in different soils.
- Soil and crop patterns are closely linked.